

Xiaowen (Winn) Ge

RESEARCHER IN
MUSIC EDUCATION
AND CREATIVITY

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Methods & Tools

Qualitative: semi-structured / video-elicited interviews, observation, thematic analysis, NVivo, PRISMA scoping reviews.

Computational: Python (librosa for music-feature extraction).

Languages

Mandarin (native), English (fluent).

Musical Practice

20 years' piano training; 13 years' vocal training in traditional Chinese folk song singing.

Conferences & Presentations

ISATT 2025, Glasgow

Quality and Aesthetics in Music Teachers' Perspectives

LKALE SIG / BAAL 2024

Exploring Multimodal Communication in Music Education

RiME 2023

Chinese Music Teachers' Perceptions of Fostering Creativity (Conference Proceedings)

UofG PhD-led Webinar, 2020

Using Digital Tools to Bridge the Distance Divide

Profile

PhD in Education (University of Glasgow, 2024) on how music teachers in China perceive creativity. Qualitative researcher in music education and creativity, with expertise in interviews, video-recorded observation and thematic analysis. Guest lecturer in qualitative methods at the University of Liverpool. Current work applies the same approach to how learners and teachers use AI tools in music education.

Research Focus

Creativity in music education — core PhD strand: drew on Csikszentmihalyi's Domain-Field-Individual model (the Field as the gatekeeper selecting which novelty is transmitted) to study how examinations, the curriculum and teachers' own training shape their views of creativity, and developed an original seven-phase spectrum of music teaching and learning. China's curriculum standards name three areas of creative work: exploring sound, improvisation and composition. Related peer-reviewed journal article forthcoming (*Music Education Research*).

Independent project

Syn-Aesthetica (2025–present). Self-initiated and unfunded, with jewellery-design collaborator Dr Dong Ding, Edinburgh College of Art. Prototype-stage Python/C++ tool designed to combine librosa feature extraction with a self-trained lightweight emotion classifier (public affective-music datasets) to drive physical, kinetic output via Dr Ding's sculptural mechanisms. My role: analysis pipeline, classifier training and the educational-evaluation framework.

Teaching Experience

Guest Lecturer, University of Liverpool

2024–present

Design and deliver standalone workshops on scoping reviews, thematic analysis (NVivo) and publication pathways for postgraduates in VR/generative-AI pedagogy and digital humanities; invited back each cohort following direct faculty feedback that the applied focus of the teaching visibly increased students' engagement and equipped them to apply the methods in their own dissertations.

Workshops and guest teaching reach approximately 60 undergraduate and postgraduate students to date, including method-specific teaching for postgraduate researchers (5 PhD) covering question framing, ethics applications, fieldwork design and write-up.

Freelance Museum Educator, National Museums Scotland; Hunterian Museum, University of Glasgow

2018–present

Research, write and deliver interpretation for school, university, public and international audiences; train and assess new guides.

Service

Reviewer, Learning Environments
Research (Springer Nature).

Education

PhD in Education — University of Glasgow

01/2019–06/2024

Thesis: *Music teachers' perceptions of creativity in the context of twenty-first century Chinese education* (viva 27 September 2023; [full text](#)).

Supervisors: Prof. Oscar Odena, Prof. Kay Livingston.

Qualitative design: 17 semi-structured interviews, 24 lesson observations, critical-incident charting, researcher diary; thematic analysis in NVivo. Produced an original seven-stage model of creativity development in music education. Key finding: conservatoire-trained instrumentalists received formal improvisation training; generalist teachers engaged with it only informally.

MSc in Education (Research) — University of Edinburgh

09/2017–08/2018

Dissertation: *The Role of Higher Education in Youth Transition to Employment*. Mixed methods, SPSS.

BA in English (Distinction) — Shandong First Medical University

09/2013–06/2017

Dissertation: *The Application of Task-based Language Teaching in IELTS Teaching*. Undergraduate research project (project lead, 4-person team): *An Analysis of Common English Learning Methods and Their Uses* — funded by a Taishan Medical University internal research grant (¥3,000).

Publications

PUBLISHED

Ge, X., Odena, O., & Livingston, K. (2026). Teachers' Perceptions of Creativity: A Practice-Informed Model from Primary School Music and Piano Teaching in China. *Research Studies in Music Education*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1321103X261460254>

ACCEPTED

Ge, X., Odena, O., & Livingston, K. (in press). Creativity in Music Education: The Influence of Policy and Experience on Piano and School Music Teachers' Perceptions in Shandong, China. *Music Education Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14613808.2026.2737846>